VASTRAWORKS / PORTFOLIO PROJECT

Growth is up. What is driving it?

A data analysis companion to the VastraWorks business dashboard: tracing sales growth, category economics and return signals in a fictional Indian fashion wholesaler.

2024 → 2025

₹6.29 Cr net sales

+19.6% year over year · 50.0% gross margin

All records and business names are fictional. Findings are descriptive, not company results.

The analysis asks what sits behind the growth

Compare the latest two complete calendar years, then segment the result to find where to investigate next.

DECISION QUESTION

Is sales growth coming from more volume, more buyers or higher value per order line - and where do margin or return signals warrant a closer look?

WHO USES THIS VIEW

A wholesale owner or operations lead who needs to review sales and factory performance without waiting for an analyst to prepare a spreadsheet.

ANALYSIS DESIGN

01 **Set a comparable period**

Full calendar years 2024 and 2025; exclude partial 2026.

02 **Define business measures**

Net sales, gross profit, margin, shipped units, active buyers, returns.

03 **Segment the signals**

Category, channel and region; compare levels and rates together.

04 **Turn patterns into questions**

Separate observed movement from causes the dataset cannot prove.

Dataset: 3,149 synthetic order lines, 2018 to 28 Oct 2026. 2026 is year-to-date; all comparisons here use complete years.

2025 growth came with more shipped volume

Sales rose 19.6%; buyer count increased more slowly, while value per order line eased slightly.

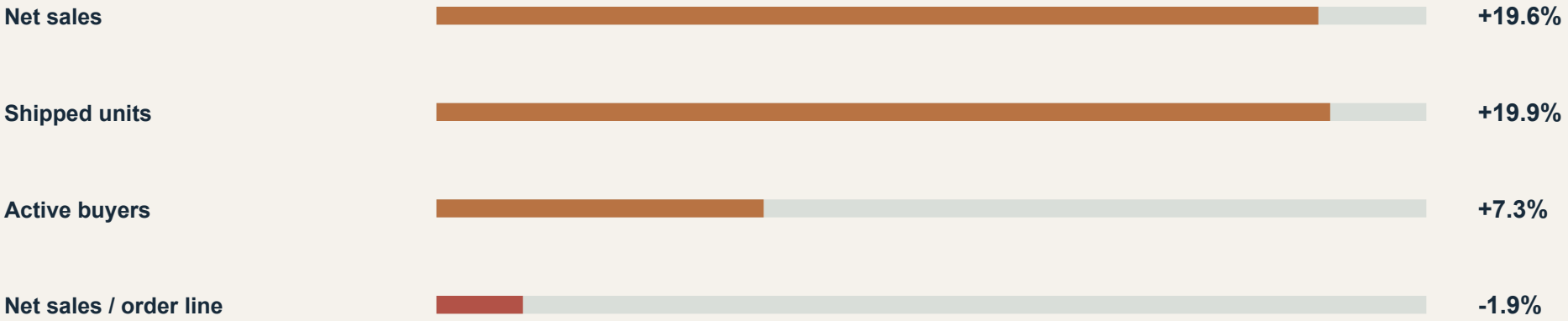
NET SALES 2024
₹5.26 Cr
2025: ₹6.29 Cr (+19.6%)

GROSS PROFIT 2024
₹2.63 Cr
2025: ₹3.15 Cr (+19.6%)

SHIPPED UNITS
34,764
2025: 41,669 (+19.9%)

ACTIVE BUYERS
110
2025: 118 (+7.3%)

2024 → 2025 CHANGE



MARGIN HELD

50.0%

Gross margin in both 2024 and 2025. Profit grew at the same pace as sales.

Read: the sales increase aligns with a 19.9% rise in shipped units. Active buyers grew 7.3%, and average sales per order line declined 1.9%. This points to a volume-led pattern in the sample; it does not identify the cause.

Two categories contributed 55% of 2025 sales

Women western wear led sales; Men apparel showed a higher gross margin at meaningful scale.

CATEGORY	NET SALES	SHARE	GROSS MARGIN	RETURN RATE
Women western wear	₹2.07 Cr	32.9%	**50.2%**	2.8%
Men apparel	₹1.40 Cr	22.3%	**53.3%**	2.5%
Kidswear	₹1.16 Cr	18.5%	**49.1%**	2.4%
Home textiles	₹0.93 Cr	14.7%	**47.0%**	2.9%
Women ethnic wear	₹0.46 Cr	7.3%	**53.1%**	2.4%
Accessories	₹0.27 Cr	4.3%	**40.4%**	2.4%

WHAT THE MIX SUGGESTS

Women western wear + Men apparel = 55.1% of sales. Men apparel's 53.3% margin is above the 50.0% business average; Accessories is lower at 40.4% on a smaller 4.3% sales share. Treat these as review priorities, not automatic assortment decisions.

The overall return rate was nearly flat

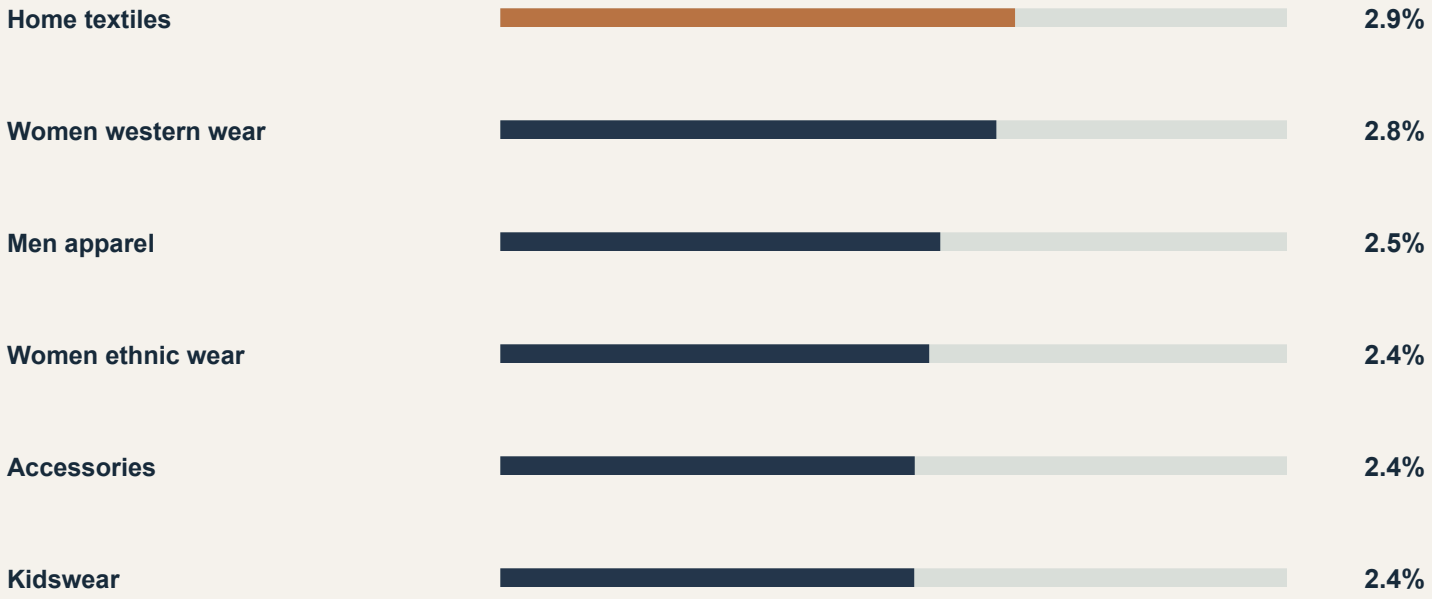
Unit return rate = returned units ÷ ordered units. Compare categories to choose where a deeper review is useful.

RETURN RATE

2.7% → 2.7%

1,133 → 1,304 units returned

2025 CATEGORY RETURN RATE



NEXT ANALYSIS

Start with Home textiles (2.9%) and compare return reasons, product/style, order channel and shipment period. Check whether the pattern persists across multiple periods and enough orders before changing policy or assortment.

Use signals to choose the next investigation

The dashboard supports focused questions; the synthetic sample does not justify operational changes on its own.

SIGNAL	WHAT THE DATA SAYS	NEXT CHECK
Volume-led growth	Shipped units +19.9%; buyers +7.3%; sales / line -1.9%.	Break out price, discounts, units per order and repeat-buyer contribution.
Margin concentration	Men apparel: 22.2% of sales, 53.3% margin.	Validate product costs and discounting before expanding this mix.
Return-rate signal	Home textiles: highest 2025 category rate at 2.9%.	Add reason codes; inspect product and channel cohorts over time.
Regional opportunity	North is largest at ₹1.64 Cr; East is next at ₹1.35 Cr.	Check buyer retention, fulfillment capacity and margin by region.

Decision rule: move from signal to action only after the pattern is validated in real order, cost, return-reason and inventory records.

Build the data needed for reliable decisions

A SIMPLE PERFORMANCE TREE

GROSS PROFIT

₹3.15 Cr · 2025 sample

NET SALES
Shipped units × realized value

GROSS MARGIN
Gross profit ÷ net sales

QUALITY GUARDRAIL
Return rate = returned units ÷ ordered units

WHO ADDS WHAT, WHERE

Operations defines reason codes and metric rules. Support records return reasons in the returns workflow by order line/SKU. Order-system owners maintain price, discount, unit cost and dates; inventory/procurement owners maintain stock and supplier lead time. Data/engineering joins the records by order ID + SKU and surfaces them in this dashboard.

REVIEW CADENCE

WEEKLY
Review sales, profit and return rates by category and channel.

MONTHLY
Validate segment signals against order records; track actions and outcomes.

Scope: fictional records; production is simulated and not reconciled to order lines or inventory. No user research or live business impact is claimed. The dashboard assistant uses fixed rules, not an AI model.